

Chapter 152_1 - Punishing Heaven

As soon as he spoke these words, everyone else immediately became alert, raising their magical weapons to look into the distance. Only Chu Qingqiu felt her spirit shake.

Tang Wenshu spoke truly—dark shadows suddenly stained the white clouds on the left side in the distance. The aura unique to the demon race had quietly descended at some unknown time. Countless clusters of black qi appeared through the sky, each cluster releasing a person. Soon, like a black locust swarm passing through, they descended in vast numbers.

"It really is the demon race!" Zen Master Feiguang summoned his vajra bell with his other hand, saying in terror, "Quickly, the demon-expelling formation!"

The disciples of Kongming Sect were most skilled at demon expulsion. Upon hearing this, they all sat cross-legged in unison, hands pressed together in prayer. Sutras transformed into golden characters surrounded by flowing light, like streams flowing from their mouths. Above the immortal sects, it was as if Buddha's light enveloped them, brilliant and dazzling.

Those characters flew up like sand, slowly surging toward the demon army. However, a white light suddenly flashed through the air, cutting off the demon-expelling sutras.

The source of the white light was precisely Chu Qingqiu. Everyone was astonished. Zen Master Feiguang frowned and stopped his sutras, while Tang Wenshu quickly faced the demon race and drew his heavy sword, turning back to ask: "Divine Venerable, what is the meaning of this?"

"They are not here to obstruct us," Chu Qingqiu said quietly. Her eyes had been fixed on the direction where the demon race appeared, until she saw a tall figure in a black robe appear at the front of the demon army. Only then did her restless heart finally settle.

"The demon race has been silent for years, but now they suddenly gather here. They must want to reap the benefits!" The Guijian Sect leader stepped forward with a dark face. "Why is the Divine Venerable speaking for the demon race?"

"The demon race has brought disaster to the world for ten thousand years. Their appearance definitely means no good. Why did the Divine Venerable interrupt our spellcasting!" A famous disciple from Kongming Sect stood up and declared loudly.

Seeing this situation, the disciples of Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate rushed to defend their sect leader, turning to counterattack one after another. For a moment, the immortal sects were in an uproar, until Chu Qingqiu could bear it no longer. She raised the white bone and struck the ground beneath her feet. The sound of wind whooshed past everyone's ears like arrows, and only then did everyone fall silent.

Just then, the trident that had been thrown earlier flew back from somewhere unknown. This time, the spearhead rushed straight toward the man's chest. Before the man or anyone else could react, the man's body was pierced through in full view of everyone, turning into a cluster of crimson water mist.

The water mist disappeared instantly, and harsh laughter echoed overhead. The transparent head that had appeared earlier reappeared in the sky, opening its strange white eyes and looking down upon everyone.

"That prophecy was indeed correct. You are the world-destroyer, the demon who brings disaster to all living beings. Now you conspire with demons—how can you argue otherwise!"

"Hmm? Ning Fuyi."

When these three words were spoken, it was like a stone stirring up a thousand waves. The immortal sect disciples who had been standing in neat formation immediately became chaotic. Many people stood on tiptoe to look toward the demon race on the opposite side, or looked at each other and whispered.

"Yiyi?" Rong Jin lifted his leg to step forward but was grabbed by Feng Ge and Hong Ying, one on each side, barely managing to hold him down.

"What did he just say? Ning Fuyi?" Liu Wenzhu frantically grabbed Hua Feihua's sleeve in panic. "How could it be Yiyi!"

Hua Feihua had just opened her mouth to console when the exclamations of nearby disciples had already drowned out their words. The person standing in front of the demons several li away had already removed her mask.

From under the hideous mask, a pair of phoenix eyes appeared first, then red lips, and finally the entire face was exposed under the heavenly light—pale as a ghost, enchanting and beautiful.

Ning Fuyi had already changed back to her original appearance. She wore pitch-black armor, her black skirt rustling loudly, the sound drowning out the clamor.

"I knew that Chuwei Hall¹ was no good thing. As the hall master of Chuwei Hall, she must have ties with the demon race!" A disciple from some unknown sect shouted loudly.

"I hate the demon race most in my life. If I had known this, I shouldn't have spared her that day at Feihua Tower!"

Ning Fuyi released her divine sense, and all the chaotic words fell into her ears. But she paid no attention to the curses and words carried by the wind, only looking across the cloud sea at the woman standing there, white as snow, as noble as always.

While she had finally confirmed her identity as a demon, standing black against white at opposite ends.

When their gazes met, Ning Fuyi saw those eyes tinge with red and unconsciously looked away, reaching back to catch the trident and return it to the bull-headed man.

"Demon Lord, why did you use my weapon?" The bull-headed man took back the trident in confusion, staring with bull eyes as he asked.

"I didn't want the Emei Thorn to touch him," Ning Fuyi said indifferently. "Dirty."

"Oh," the bull-headed man laughed heartily.

Fragrance came from behind as a woman with a graceful figure walked to Ning Fuyi's side, her soft hand resting on her shoulder: "Are you afraid?"

"What's there to be afraid of?" Ning Fuyi answered.

Now it was different from her previous life. Although she was again recognized as a demon by all living beings, it was completely different.

"Indeed, there's nothing to be afraid of," Jiuying lowered her hand, flames leaping in her palm, the corners of her lips curling up. "This divine beast will live and die with you."

Ning Fuyi lowered her phoenix eyes, smiling until her dimples deepened, then suddenly soared into the air. With her long arm raised high, the Emei Thorn awakened the azure sky overhead. Immediately, dark clouds rolled and pink lightning shook heaven and earth.

Under such thunder, the immortal sect members on the opposite side all raised their magical weapons, as if facing a great enemy. The Guijian Sect leader raised his arm and shouted: "Ning Fuyi! You demon, do you really want to attack the immortal sects that raised you!"

Ning Fuyi turned a deaf ear to their shouting and anger, focusing only on circulating her power. The immortal force within her body surged with the rolling clouds, bright pink gathering into a whirlpool above her head.

"It's Sect Leader Ningtian's self-created technique, Nine Provinces Wind and Thunder! She actually wants to use this against the immortal sects!" Someone shouted loudly, the voice echoing through the crowd.

Thus, within several li, there was complete silence. The immortal sect members, including various sect leaders, hurriedly circulated their power to form arrays, gritting their teeth to prepare for the dual attack from the demon race and Penglai.

However, just as the tension in the air was about to snap, Ning Fuyi standing in mid-air suddenly let out a fierce shout. The whirlpool mixed with lightning suddenly struck out, but halfway through, the whirlpool changed direction.

With a thunderous crash that could split clouds and crack stones, even the mountains and rivers beneath their feet shook three times. Strong winds carrying lightning plunged into the hundred-zhang-high waterfall, and then the entire stone beam broke, and the great gate for entering and leaving Penglai was destroyed in the blink of an eye.

Accompanied by the earth-shaking noise, the transparent head that had been watching like a spectacle suddenly roared in anger, then disappeared without a trace. After that, like the Milky Way bursting its banks, water enough to submerge an entire country gushed out.

Seeing the bursting water about to flow into the mortal realm, Chu Qingqiu, who had been silent all along, waved her sleeve and released the Jade Pure Opening Cloud Vase. The vase body immediately expanded, absorbing all the rushing water.

While the immortal sect members had not yet recovered from their shock, Ning Fuyi had already spoken. Though her voice was low, it echoed throughout the cloud sea.

"Penglai appears bright on the outside but is rotten within, wearing the name of immortals while practicing the ways of demons! They planted villains in Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate, causing the death of Divine Venerable Chu Ling and nearly destroying the sect. To seize the Jade Pure Vase, they slaughtered all the people of Cangyun Kingdom. To forge the Wuji ghost fire, they sacrificed countless lives from Xuanyuan Kingdom. They also stripped many people of their memories, training them as puppets to serve them! Each and every one of these acts was done by Tianrui!"

"Therefore, hear my command, all demons. To protect all living beings—"

Ning Fuyi stood with her back to them in mid-air, coldly uttering a few words: "Kill Emperor Tianrui!"

"Kill!" As soon as her words fell, the bull-headed man and various demon kings behind her roared and charged toward Penglai's barrier, with countless demon soldiers following closely. From afar, it looked like dark clouds pressing down on the city, breaking through the barrier in an instant.

Once the barrier was broken, countless immortal soldiers also shouted and charged out. When the two armies met, the smell of blood had already spread.

The immortal sects had not expected that the demon race was actually targeting Penglai. For a moment, they didn't react until Chu Qingqiu shouted, "What are you standing there for?" Only then did the sect leaders snap out of their shock and turn to give orders.

Thus, the immortal sect disciples also surged toward Penglai like a human sea. Immediately, black, white, and colorful figures merged together, various immortal powers converging into colorful clouds, spreading through the air accompanied by a faint smell of blood.

The great battle was about to begin. Seeing the chaos in front of them, Jiuying clutched her fire seed excitedly: "Ning Fuyi, where are we going?"

"Take advantage of the chaos to find Emperor Tianrui," Ning Fuyi looked toward Penglai, which was suddenly shrouded in thick fog, her expression complex. She had a premonition that this journey would definitely not be simple, but there was no other choice.

"Can we still contact Shiqi?" Ning Fuyi asked, receiving a shake of the head from Jiuying.

"There's been no news for several days. Her life or death is unknown."

Ning Fuyi nodded without saying more, leaping up with Jiuying, sweeping over the fighting crowd below and heading straight for Penglai.

She couldn't help searching for that white-robed figure in mid-air, never finding her, but glimpsed many familiar figures. Where Kongming Sect was located, Buddha's light shone everywhere. Zen Master Feiguang's vajra bell transformed into steel rings, binding a group of immortal soldiers within.

Where Hehuan Sect passed, intoxicating fragrances filled the air, leaving immortal soldiers weak and collapsed, while countless demon soldiers shuttled through, with Shangchou and various demon kings charging at the front, both fiercely attacking immortal generals and letting out piercing roars and howls.

The area closest to Penglai had the most intense fighting. Only countless people could be heard shouting in alarm, then air waves erupted from the front lines, countless disciples were blown away by the air waves. The source was actually a giant immortal beast standing tall as heaven and earth, breathing fire from its mouth, forcing everyone to retreat.

In the crowd, someone suddenly stepped forward, a thousand-pound hammer dragging sparks across the ground. Then the thousand-pound hammer flew out, striking the massive immortal beast and making it cry out in a long wail.

Seeing the immortal beast about to trample over that person's head, Ning Fuyi quickly landed from mid-air. The immortal force in her hands moved faster than her thoughts, already forming a pink barrier blocking the immortal beast's path. Then Jiuying spread her long hair in mid-air, and a qilin formed of flames opened its giant mouth behind her.

Thus, the divine beast's roar seemed to come from ancient times. Everyone present felt intimidated, and the immortal beast was also suppressed, whimpering as it returned to its original form.

Ning Fuyi steadied Liu Wenzhu with one hand and gripped the wildly spinning Emei Thorn that had sensed the bloody qi with the other. Standing firm in the strong wind, she suddenly felt a burning sensation at her nose tip and quickly pulled Liu Wenzhu back, shouting: "It's Wuji ghost fire, be careful!"

Nearby immortal sect disciples heard this and quickly scattered. Just as the all-consuming ghost fire was about to gush out, dozens of black iron puppets descended from the sky, using their bodies to block the oncoming fire points.

As those puppets melted into molten iron, cold wind suddenly came from behind. Ning Fuyi felt frost flowers appear around her, then the gentle fragrance of gardenia diffused through the air, gradually covering the nauseating smell.

A figure landed in front of her, white robes stepping over mountains of corpses, landing spotlessly at her feet. A low humming sound flowed out, and the Jade Pure Vase in Chu Qingqiu's hand suddenly rose to the sky. Accompanied by several thunderclaps, gentle rain began to fall.

The fine rain fell softly, like the most ordinary spring rain in the world. Wherever it reached, the ghost fire immediately withered and slowly extinguished.

"Hua Feihua, you control the puppets to guard this place, try your best to block those immortal soldiers. Others with exceptional immortal power, follow this venerable to attack Penglai and find Emperor Tianrui," Chu Qingqiu's voice was cold. "If anyone is injured, carry them to the rear. Divine Doctor Jiang and the Jiang family will treat them."

"Yes, Divine Venerable," Hua Feihua said, pulling Liu Wenzhu over and activating the bronze ring in her palm. Dozens more puppets descended from the sky, surrounding Penglai's entrance until it was watertight.

Ning Fuyi was about to say something when a cold hand took her fingertips. That hand became burning hot the moment it touched her.

"Yiyi, let's go," Chu Qingqiu changed her tone and said quietly.

Ning Fuyi looked at her for a few moments, then gripped her hand in return. The two transformed into points of light, soaring into Penglai.

As soon as they set foot on Penglai's soil, dense cold light rushed toward them. That cold light came from the armor of immortal soldiers and generals. Before Ning Fuyi could raise her eyes, dozens of long blades were already chopping down from above.

Ordinary immortal soldiers were nothing to her. Ning Fuyi didn't even need to look up—air currents burst from around her, carving out a path in front of them. The arched bridge broke, white jade railings also turned to fragments, and the flower garden shrouded in immortal mist immediately became ruins.

Ning Fuyi quickly stepped over those ruins, heading straight for Penglai Hall. She and Chu Qingqiu passed through gate after gate. After stepping through the final door, the immortal soldiers who had been blocking them layer by layer suddenly disappeared. Before them was like entering a courtyard, leisurely and tranquil.

On both sides, lotus flowers grew in pools, with water drops falling above the lotus flowers. The sound of dripping water echoed, ethereal and quiet. The magnificent golden hall towered high, casting thick shadows.

Short towers stood on both sides of the hall, with copper bells at the tower tops making melodious music, eerily echoing with the sounds of slaughter outside the gates.

Two people stood on steps that numbered in the hundreds, seemingly having waited there for a long time. One wore silver robes and had an upright bearing—this was Wen Yao Jun. The other had curly hair falling to his waist, a slender build, and eyes clear as jewels.

It was Yun Ke.

Only his eyes no longer held any ripples, like a deep pool about to dry up, leaving only deathly silence.

Ning Fuyi gripped her sleeves tightly, hatred suddenly rising in her heart.

At this time, others had also broken in. Seeing the two silently standing figures, they all stopped and gripped their magical weapons tightly.

Footnotes:

1. **Chuwei Hall (懋畏堂)** - A name Ning Fuyi used as a cover identity when operating in the immortal realm